METRO CITY MUNICIPAL CORPORATION - CITIZEN SERVICES & COMPLIANCE CIRCULAR (2025)

Section 1: Residential Property Tax Assessment & Rebate Schemes

1.1 Annual Property Tax Deadlines The property tax cycle for Metro City corresponds to the financial year (April 1 to March 31). Annual property tax demands are issued on May 1st each year. Taxes may be paid in a single lump sum or in two equal bi-annual installments due on June 30th and December 31st.

1.2 Early Payment and Green Energy Rebates Citizens can avail of substantial financial rebates under certified civic initiatives: (a) Early Bird Incentive: An immediate 10% rebate on total net property tax is awarded if the entire annual assessment is settled before June 30th. (b) Rainwater Harvesting Rebate: Properties with certified, functional rainwater harvesting percolation pits receive a recurring 5% annual rebate on property tax. (c) Solar Rooftop Rebate: Residential buildings equipped with grid-tied solar photovoltaic installations of at least 3 kW capacity receive an additional 6% rebate. The maximum combined rebate under all municipal incentive programs shall not exceed 20% of gross property tax liability. Late payments settled after March 31st incur penal interest at 1.5% per month compounded quarterly.

Section 2: Building Plan Sanction and Construction Permits

2.1 Residential Building Permit Turnaround Under the Fast-Track Municipal Citizen Charter: • Low-Risk Residential Plots (up to 200 sq. meters, max height 10 meters): Automatic deemed online approval generated within 7 business days upon submission of registered architect certification. • Standard Residential Plots (201 to 500 sq. meters): Mandatory review turnaround is 21 working days. If no objection or defect notice is communicated within 21 working days, deemed sanction is legally applicable. • Commercial and High-Rise Structures: Multi-departmental scrutiny (Fire Safety, Water Board, Traffic Police) completed within 45 working days.

2.2 Tree Preservation and Felling Regulations No citizen or contractor may fell any mature tree (trunk circumference > 30 cm) on private or public land without prior written approval from the Metro City Tree Officer: • Mandatory Compensatory Plantation: The applicant must plant ten (10) native saplings for every single tree felled and maintain them for three years. • Unauthorized Felling Penalty: Violators will face a non-bailable civil penalty of $500 per tree plus mandatory restorative replantation.

Section 3: Drinking Water Connections, Waste Management & Grievance Redressal

3.1 New Potable Water Supply Connection Citizens applying for a domestic water connection must register on the Citizen Portal: • Application Fee: $25 non-refundable verification charge. • Connection Deposit: $150 refundable infrastructure security deposit. • Meter Installation Guarantee: Water line tapping and smart digital meter installation must be completed within 14 calendar days of deposit confirmation.

3.2 Municipal Solid Waste Segregation Mandate All households and commercial establishments are legally required to segregate garbage at source into three color-coded bins: • Green Bin: Wet Biodegradable organic food waste. • Blue Bin: Dry Recyclable paper, plastic, metals, and glass. • Red Bin: Domestic hazardous and sanitary waste. Non-segregated waste will not be collected by municipal sanitation vehicles. Repeat non-compliance after two formal written warnings attracts a fine of $25 for the first violation and $50 for each subsequent breach.

3.3 Citizen Grievance Escalation Hierarchy Civic service complaints (water supply failure, street lighting, pothole repair) logged on the Helpline (1800-444-MCMC) follow a strict 3-tier Service Level Agreement (SLA): • Level 1: Ward Field Engineer — Resolution window: 48 hours. • Level 2: Executive Municipal Engineer — Escalation triggered if unresolved in 48 hours; resolution window: 72 hours. • Level 3: Municipal Commissioner Public Hearing — Direct intervention every Wednesday 10:00 AM to 1:00 PM for grievances unresolved past 7 days.